Property access

This operator is provided by `.` or by `[]`. You use them to access a property on an object:

```
texasRanger = actor: 'Chuck Norris'
texasRanger.actor
# 'Chuck Norris'
```

An object defining a single property, actor

Square brackets are useful when you have the property name in a value:

```
movie = title: 'Way of the Dragon', star: 'Bruce Lee'
myPropertyName = 'title'
movie[myPropertyName]
# 'Way of the Dragon'
```

An object defining two properties: title and star

A date object has a `getHours` property that can be used to get the hours part of a date. You can invoke that function on the date object created using the `new` operator:

```
now = new Date()
# Sun, 21 Aug 2011 00:14:34 GMT
now.getHours()
# 0
```

Objects and properties are covered in depth in chapter 4. You can now turn your eyes to types of things in CoffeeScript.

2.3.2. Types, existential, and combining operators

CoffeeScript has some operators that are not in JavaScript. These operators provide cleaner syntax for some common JavaScript idioms. One of these, called the existential operator, is useful for expressions such as “is there a house roast?”

```
houseRoast?
```

To understand the existential operator, you need to understand `undefined`, `null`, and types.